

VCT Quant · Terminal Arena design spec

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Overview

VCT Quant ships in the **Terminal Arena** direction: a dense, dark odds board that borrows the look of a tactical shooter's menus, with cut-corner panels, slanted chips and segmented bars. It forecasts Valorant Champions Tour matches with an Elo model and sets each forecast beside the Polymarket price.

Audience. About 10 friends who follow VCT closely but are not quants. They open it on phones from a Discord link, right before or during a match. Design at 390 px first, then scale to 1200 px.

The job. Monitor and compare: glance at win chances, see where the model and the market disagree, drill into one match. There is no landing page, hero section or feature grid.

Principles

- **Numbers are the hero.** Win chances use JetBrains Mono with tabular figures. Team tags are the second hero.
- **Two series colours, everywhere:** chartreuse for the model, pink for the market. White marks the result or winner and nothing else.
- **Structure by rules, density and type.** A panel is used only for a separate object: a match, a series outcome, a map.
- **Game language without Riot IP:** cut corners, slants, segmented bars, corner brackets and banners. No Valorant logo, agent art or Riot red.
- **Honest by default:** every forecast says where it comes from, and missing data is a designed state, not a gap.
- **Dark first,** with a real light theme; both meet WCAG AA.

Reference boards: the "3b · Terminal Arena" row of the VCT Quant Redesign canvas.

Colour

Three roles carry meaning: **model** (chartreuse), **market** (pink) and **result** (white in dark, near-black in light). Everything else is a toned green-grey neutral. The model and market colours differ in lightness as well as hue, and also in shape: the model is a slanted square or bar, the market a triangle notch or diamond. So they stay distinct for colour-blind readers.

Token	Dark	Light	Use
<code>--bg</code>	#07090A	#F3F5F1	Page
<code>--surface-1</code>	#101412	#E9EDE6	Panels: match card, outcome tile
<code>--surface-2</code>	#161B18	#DFE4DB	Raised: stat cell, banner, active tab
<code>--surface-3</code>	#1E2421	#D3D9CE	Chips, empty track
<code>--line</code>	#2A322D	#C3CABD	Rules, panel borders
<code>--line-strong</code>	#333D37	#A9B1A3	Logo slot border, dividers in bugs
<code>--text</code>	#E6ECE7	#0B0D0C	Primary copy, numbers
<code>--text-2</code>	#B9C3BC	#2F3631	Secondary copy, team full names
<code>--text-3</code>	#8A948D	#545D56	Meta, labels, the less likely side's %
<code>--text-ph</code>	#58625B	#8A928B	Placeholders and decoration only. Fails AA: never real copy
<code>--model</code>	#C8F25C	#4E6B00	Model %, filled pips, the model marker
<code>--model-2</code>	#7E9440	#9DB05C	Model bars for the other side
<code>--model-off</code>	#34401A	#D2DDB0	Unfilled pips
<code>--market</code>	#FF7AB8	#B0245F	Market %, notch, diamond, BIG GAP chip, UPSET badge
<code>--market-wash</code>	#FF7AB8 at 35%	#B0245F at 22%	The span between model and market on a gap track
<code>--result</code>	#FFFFFF	#0B0D0C	Winner frame, WIN/RESULT tags, W in form

Token	Dark	Light	Use
<code>--result-ink</code>	#07090A	#F3F5F1	Text on a result fill
<code>--logo-plate</code>	#1A201C	#FFFFFF	Logo slot backing
<code>--logo-plate-dark</code>	#C9D1CB	#FFFFFF	Backing for near-black logos in dark theme

Contrast. `--text-3` on `--surface-1` is about 5.8:1 in dark, and `--model` and `--market` pass AA as text on every surface. Light-theme model and market are darkened so they pass as text; the bright chartreuse is dark-theme only. Fills that carry meaning (pips, notches) keep at least 3:1 against their background.

Rules. Never use the model colour for anything that is not the model. Pink appears only for the market and for statements about the market being right (UPSET). No gradients: the only transparency is `--market-wash`.

Typography

Two self-hosted families: **Chakra Petch** (500, 600, 700) for words and team tags, and **JetBrains Mono** (400, 500, 700, 800) for every number, time and meta line.

Style	Family	Size / line	Weight	Notes
Display	Chakra Petch	34 / 1.0	700	Page title, uppercase (GROUP STAGE)
H1	Chakra Petch	28 / 1.1	700	Match title on desktop
H2 section	Chakra Petch	20 / 1.0	700	Uppercase, +0.06em, followed by a hairline rule
Tag	Chakra Petch	24 / 1.0	700	+0.03em; 30 on the match scoreboard
Body	Chakra Petch	15 / 1.45	500	Explanations and honesty lines
Label	Chakra Petch	13 / 1.2	700	Uppercase, +0.06em: EVENT, CALLS, nav
Banner	Chakra Petch	13 / 1.0	700	Uppercase, +0.2em: MATCH COMPLETE

Style	Family	Size / line	Weight	Notes
Num XL	JetBrains Mono	44 / 1.0	800	Series score
Num L	JetBrains Mono	26 / 1.0	800	Win % on a match card
Num M	JetBrains Mono	20–22 / 1.0	800	Stat cells, outcome tiles
Num S	JetBrains Mono	15 / 1.2	700	Kick-off time, market % inline
Meta	JetBrains Mono	12 / 1.3	400	Stage, dates, axis labels

Numeric rules

- Always `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums` so columns of percentages align.
- Win chances show one decimal (53.5), without the % sign when the column or legend already says it.
- Gaps are signed with a true minus (–16.0, +8.8) and read as model minus market for team A.
- The favoured side's number is in the model colour; the other side's is `--text-3`.
- Times are 24-hour and in the viewer's local time, with a countdown chip (T–14H, T–3D).

Space, shape and motion

Spacing runs on a 4 px base: 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32. The phone gutter is 12 px, panels sit 10 px apart, and sections open with 22 px above their heading.

Cut corners, not radii. Nothing is rounded. Panels clip their top-left and bottom-right corners with `clip-path`:

Size	Cut	Used on
Large	14 px	Match card, scoreboard panel, event select
Medium	8 px	Outcome tile, stat cell, map row

Size	Cut	Used on
Small	6 px	Logo slot

A bordered panel is two nested clipped layers: the outer one is `--line` (or `--result` for a winner) with 1–2 px padding.

Slant. Chips, tags, pips and the active nav tab are skewed by -14° , with their text counter-skewed so it stays upright. Numbers and body copy are never slanted.

Corner brackets. Four 12 px L-shapes in `--model` frame the one panel per page that matters most: the model-vs-market gap on a match.

Hit targets. Every tappable thing is at least 44×44 px, including nav tabs, the back link and "Last 20 maps".

Motion. State changes only, 120 ms with `cubic-bezier(.2, 0, 0, 1)`: tab underline, chip fill, pips filling on first render. No looping animation except the live dot. With `prefers-reduced-motion`, all durations are 0 and the live dot is static.

Components

Every component reads its colours from the tokens, so it works in both themes unchanged.

Logo slot

A square with a 6 px cut: `--logo-plate` backing, a 1 px `--line-strong` border, and the logo `object-fit: contain` with 12% padding. Sizes: 20 px (dense rows), 34 px (match card), 56 px (scoreboard).

- **Near-black logos** (EDG, Paper Rex) get `--logo-plate-dark` in dark theme so they don't vanish. Mark them with a `darkLogo` flag per team.
- **Wordmarks** (100T, NRG) are contained, never cropped.
- **Missing logo** falls back to the tag, or the first three letters of the name, in JetBrains Mono 700 on the same plate. Mega Minors, which has no tag, shows MM.
- **Losing side** on a finished match drops to 70% opacity.

Team name and tag

The tag is the default label (PRX, 100T, G2), in Chakra Petch 700 uppercase. The full name appears where there is room: scoreboard, rankings, match page. Teams with no tag (T1, NRG, MIBR, Mega Minors) use the name, which is already short. Long names (Nongshim RedForce, EDward Gaming) truncate on one line with an ellipsis and never wrap. Screen readers always get the full name.

Pip bar (win probability)

Twenty slanted blocks, 12 px tall with 2 px gaps, each 5% of team A's chance. Filled blocks are `--model` ; the rest are `--model-off` . The market is a pink triangle notch above the bar at its exact %, not rounded to a block. With no market the notch is absent. On outcome tiles the bar is 10 blocks of 4% each.

Gap chip

A slanted chip after the market line, reading model minus market for team A.

Case	Look	Example
Gap under 1 pt	Grey chip, "AGREE"	JDG +0.5 would read "Δ +0.5 · AGREE"
Gap 1-10 pts	<code>--surface-3</code> chip, <code>--text</code>	Δ +8.8 (G2)
Gap 10 pts or more	<code>--market</code> fill, <code>--result-ink</code> text, "BIG GAP"	BIG GAP Δ -16.0 (100T)
No market	No chip; "MKT --.- · NO PRICE YET" in <code>-text-ph</code> , the model's read on the right	NRG FAVOURED

Match card (Matches list)

A large-cut panel, and the whole card is one link to the match page. Its rows, top to bottom:

1. Kick-off time, countdown chip, stage and best-of.
2. Logo and tag, team A %, VS, team B %, then tag and logo.
3. Pip bar with the market notch.
4. Market % for each side and the gap chip.

Scoreboard (match page)

Three columns: team panel, score, team panel. The winner's panel gets a 2 px `--result` frame and a slanted WIN tag; the loser's text drops to `--text-3`. Above it sits a MATCH COMPLETE banner (or LIVE, or kick-off time and countdown before the match). An UPSET badge follows whenever the model's favourite lost.

Gap panel (match page)

The model-vs-market panel is framed by corner brackets. It holds a 0-100 track for team A, with the model as a slanted chartreuse block and the market as a pink triangle. A pink wash spans the distance between them, and a bracket above is labelled Δ with the gap. The result is marked at 0 or 100. Three stat cells follow: MODEL, MARKET, CALL (HIT or MISS, with the favourite's name).

Outcome tiles

A 2×2 grid of series scores (2-0, 2-1, 1-2, 0-2 for a Bo3), each with a % and a 10-block bar. The one that happened gets a `--result` frame and a RESULT tag. The note under the grid gives the sweep chance and says the split assumes independent maps.

Table rows

Rows are 44 px minimum, separated by `--line` hairlines, with no zebra striping.

- **Rankings:** rank (mono), logo, name and tag, rating (mono 700), and matches this season. Fewer than 10 matches adds a LOW DATA chip (NRG, 9).
- **Results:** score, model's last pre-match % for the winner, market %, and a slanted UPSET chip when the favourite lost.
- **Track record:** date, match, model %, market %, CALL HIT or MISS, and log loss.

Chart

The chart is hand-written SVG and every line is stepped: each forecast holds until the next one is logged. Model and market lines are 2.5 px. Gridlines are `--surface-2`, and the 50% line is dashed `--line`. End markers match the series shapes (slanted square, triangle), and a dashed `--result` line marks START. Axis labels are Meta size in `--text-3`, at most three per axis. There is no legend box; label the ends directly.

Navigation and controls

The top bar has a slanted chartreuse wordmark block, then tabs with the active one slanted on `--surface-2` with a 3 px `--model` underline. Overflow goes to a menu button (MATCHES, RESULTS, RANKS, then more). Selects are cut-corner panels at 44 px. The primary button is a slanted `--model` fill with `--result-ink` text; the secondary button is a 1 px `--line-strong` outline.

States

Missing data is normal, so each case below has a designed look and a plain sentence. None of them uses a new colour.

State	When	What shows
No market	No Polymarket price matched the fixture	No notch or chip. "MKT --.· NO PRICE YET" in <code>--text-ph</code> , and the model's read ("NRG FAVOURED") on the right
Thin market	Spread above 0.10	Market % in <code>--text-3</code> , not pink, with a WIDE SPREAD chip. It is left out of the grading, as the grader already does
Low data	A team has fewer than 10 rated matches this season	LOW DATA chip beside the tag. Pip bar in outline blocks, not filled. Line: "NRG has 9 rated matches this season, so this rating moves fast."
Placeholder data	A field not yet in the feed (map names, round scores, form)	<code>--text-ph</code> brackets, e.g. [MAP]. Form blocks are dashed outlines with ?
Empty list	No upcoming matches for the filter	Display line "NO MATCHES SCHEDULED", one sentence naming the next known event, and a button to switch the filter to All Tier 1

State	When	What shows
Loading	First fetch	The card layout with <code>--surface-1</code> blocks where text goes, and all 20 pips in <code>--model-off</code> . No spinner and no shimmer
Refreshing	Refresh after <code>vct update</code>	Existing numbers stay; the live chip reads SYNCING. Changed numbers flash <code>--surface-2</code> for 120 ms
Stale	Payload older than 6 hours	Meta line under the header: "Forecasts from [time]. The data desk has not updated since."
Error	<code>/api/snapshot</code> fails	Cut-corner panel with a 1 px <code>--line-strong</code> border: "COULDN'T REACH THE DATA DESK", one line with the last good time, and a secondary Retry button. Cached cards stay visible below it
Live	Match in progress (<code>/api/live</code>)	Banner reads LIVE with a pulsing <code>-market</code> dot (static with reduced motion). The pre-match % is frozen and labelled "PRE-MATCH"
Not found	Unknown match id	"NO MATCH #[id]" and a link back to Matches

Pages

Each page is built from the components above. At 1200 px, Matches becomes two columns of cards, and the Match page puts scoreboard and gap panel on the left, outcomes and chart on the right.

Page	Route	Content	Main components
Home	/	Current event and stage, the next 3–5 matches, and one record line ("Model picked the winner in 4 of 6 graded Champions matches"). No stat tiles	Match card, record bar
Matches	/matches	Upcoming matches grouped by day in local time, with an event filter	Match card, select, empty state
Match	/match/:id	Scoreboard; model, market and gap; outcome split; pre-match chart; last 5 and last 20 maps; head-to-head. After the match: final score, maps and CALL	Scoreboard, gap panel, outcome tiles, chart
Rankings	/rankings	Elo table and a head-to-head picker showing the neutral-stage win chance	Ranking row, two selects, pip bar
Results	/results	Finished matches with score, model %, market % and UPSET; Tier 1 / Game Changers filter	Result row, slanted filter chips
Champions 2026	/champions	Four GSL groups of 4, each team's playoff chance, results so far	Group table, pip bar per team
Edge	/edge	Largest model-market gaps and the paper-trade ledger (entry odds, result, units). Labelled "Paper trading. No real money."	Gap chip, ledger rows
Track record	/record	Calibration chart, log loss vs a coin flip and vs the market, every graded call	Chart, record rows

Page	Route	Content	Main components
Team / Player	<code>/team/:id</code> , <code>/player/:id</code>	Team results and maps; player map stats	Result rows, map rows

The record bar is the one summary figure allowed at the top of Matches and Home: CALLS as a segmented bar (4 of 6 filled), with log loss against coin flip and market in one Meta line.

Copy and do-nots

The interface speaks in short uppercase labels (MATCHES, CALLS, BIG GAP) and plain sentences for anything explanatory. The honesty lines are fixed copy:

- Under every forecast: "Model is Elo ratings only: no map veto or roster news."
- Market: "Last traded price before start."
- Outcome split: "Derived from the series chance, treating maps as independent."
- Upset: "Model missed. It had GE at 60.6; the market's 45.5 was right." Name the side that was right, whichever it was.
- Edge: "Paper trading. No real money."

Do not

- Use rounded white cards with shadows, gradients or glassmorphism.
- Put eyebrow labels above headings, icons above headings, or a coloured strip on the left of a card.
- Add stat tiles that don't help a decision ("39,505 matches in the database").
- Use Inter, Roboto or a system font.
- Use Riot IP: the Valorant logo, agent art or Riot's red.
- Invent numbers. A missing value is a placeholder or an empty state, never a guess.

Tokens (CSS)

Paste into the top of the app's single stylesheet. Dark is the default; set `data-theme="light"` on `<html>` for light.

```

:root {
  /* type */
  --font-display: 'Chakra Petch', system-ui, sans-serif;
  --font-num: 'JetBrains Mono', ui-monospace, monospace;
  --fs-display: 34px; --fs-h1: 28px; --fs-h2: 20px; --fs-body: 15px;
  --fs-label: 13px; --fs-meta: 12px; --fs-tag: 24px;
  --fs-num-xl: 44px; --fs-num-l: 26px; --fs-num-m: 20px; --fs-num-s: 15px;
  --lh-tight: 1; --lh-body: 1.45;
  --track-label: .06em; --track-banner: .2em;

  /* space, shape, motion */
  --s-1: 4px; --s-2: 8px; --s-3: 12px; --s-4: 16px; --s-5: 24px; --s-6: 32px;
  --gutter: 12px; --hit: 44px;
  --cut-l: 14px; --cut-m: 8px; --cut-s: 6px;
  --slant: -14deg;
  --dur: 120ms; --ease: cubic-bezier(.2, 0, 0, 1);

  /* colour: dark (default) */
  color-scheme: dark;
  --bg: #07090A;
  --surface-1: #101412; --surface-2: #161B18; --surface-3: #1E2421;
  --line: #2A322D; --line-strong: #333D37;
  --text: #E6ECE7; --text-2: #B9C3BC; --text-3: #8A948D;
  --text-ph: #58625B;
  --model: #C8F25C; --model-2: #7E9440; --model-off: #34401A;
  --market: #FF7AB8; --market-wash: rgba(255, 122, 184, .35);
  --result: #FFFFFF; --result-ink: #07090A;
  --logo-plate: #1A201C; --logo-plate-dark: #C9D1CB;
}

:root[data-theme="light"] {
  color-scheme: light;
  --bg: #F3F5F1;
  --surface-1: #E9EDE6; --surface-2: #DFE4DB; --surface-3: #D3D9CE;
  --line: #C3CABD; --line-strong: #A9B1A3;
  --text: #0B0D0C; --text-2: #2F3631; --text-3: #545D56;
  --text-ph: #8A928B;
  --model: #4E6B00; --model-2: #9DB05C; --model-off: #D2DDB0;
  --market: #B0245F; --market-wash: rgba(176, 36, 95, .22);
  --result: #0B0D0C; --result-ink: #F3F5F1;
  --logo-plate: #FFFFFF; --logo-plate-dark: #FFFFFF;
}

```

```

@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) {
  :root { --dur: 0ms; }
}

/* shape helpers */
.cut-l { clip-path: polygon(var(--cut-l) 0, 100% 0, 100% calc(100% - var(--cut-l)), calc(100% - var(--cut-l)) 100%, 0 100%, 0 var(--cut-l)); }
.cut-m { clip-path: polygon(var(--cut-m) 0, 100% 0, 100% calc(100% - var(--cut-m)), calc(100% - var(--cut-m)) 100%, 0 100%, 0 var(--cut-m)); }
.slant { transform: skewX(var(--slant)); }
.slant > * { display: inline-block; transform: skewX(calc(var(--slant) * -1)); }
.num { font-family: var(--font-num); font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums; }

```

The app should follow the OS theme until the viewer picks one. Set `data-theme` from `prefers-color-scheme` on load, then from a saved choice.

Open questions

- ☐ **Record line:** the live UI shows log loss 0.600 over 8 graded matches, and the brief says 4 of 6. How many of the 8 did the model call right?
- ☐ **Data feeds:** map names and round scores, last 5 with opponents and dates, and head-to-head are placeholders in the mock-ups. Confirm which are already in the payload.
- ☐ **Price history:** the chart needs each logged forecast with a timestamp from `prediction_log.parquet`, plus market snapshots. Does the payload expose them?
- ☐ **Dark logos:** list the teams whose logos need `--logo-plate-dark` (EDG and Paper Rex at least).
- ☐ **Low data threshold:** 10 rated matches this season is a starting guess.
- ☐ **Big gap threshold:** 10 points is a starting guess. It could match the Edge page's cut-off instead.